

Course Description

How do nature and environment figure in both our ordinary and scientific discourses? The term environment mostly refers to the things which remain outside the human and social sphere, often hiding the complex relations of dependence and contiguity that define the human-environment nexus. Ecology is the field which investigates this nexus. In this course, we will study the main themes and ideas of the ecological debate, which intersects with hard sciences, technology and social sciences at the same time. This debate is roughly 150 years old and has contributions from across the board, from zoologists and geologists to poets and activists.

This course is divided into four parts.

- Lectures
- Thought Experiments and Case Studies
- Films/Documentaries
- Research Report along with the viva

Main Themes and Topics:

1. The Idea of Nature: From Greeks to Modern Times (Hadot)
 - a. Politics of Nature (Latour)
2. The Logic of Totemic Classification
3. Environmentalism and the Rise of Ecological Thought
 1. Wilderness and The American Tradition – Rachel Carson
 2. Biophilia and Consilience – Wilson
 3. Birth of Ecological Economics – Georgescu Roegen
 4. Buddhist Economics-E. F. Schumacher
 5. Gaya Hypothesis– Lynn Margulis and Jame Lovelock
 6. Gandhi's Environmentalism
 7. Ecological Thought – India (Patrick Geddes and Lewis Mumford)
4. The Ecological Debate
 1. Diversity and the Biotech Imagination
 2. Sustainability and Ecological Security. Reading Brundtland.
 3. Risk: Ulrich Beck and Beyond – (Mary Douglas, Beck and Scott Lash)
 4. Waste, Garbage, Pollution and Obsolescence (Thompson, Parry, Douglas, Kristeva)
 5. Ecology of Food (Douglas, Cohn, Khare)

6. Cattle (Marvin Harris, Evans-Pritchard)